

Advent Wreath Reading

Christmas Eve: The Christ Candle

READER ONE:

The season of Advent has been a time of expectation and of preparation. For the last four Sundays, as we have waited in wonder, we have lit candles to remind us of several things about the Gift of Christmas. We lit the candle of Hope, which reminded us that we must live expectantly in hope as we celebrate Christ's first coming and as we anticipate His coming again. We lit the candle Peace, and we focused on preparing ourselves to receive the gift of peace that the Prince of Peace can bring to our hearts as we allow Him to reign. We lit the candle of Joy, as we celebrated the abundant life that is ours in Christ and the joy that is the by-product of God's revelation. We lit the candle of Love that celebrated God's amazing love for us that gave Jesus to the World.

READER TWO:

All through this Advent season, we have been anticipating the time when we would light the center candle, the Christ candle, which represents the purity of Christ Himself, and we could celebrate that Christ has come indeed. The time has come! [light center candle] We proclaim that Christ has come, and that He is Emmanuel, God with us. He is the Light of the World and the light of our hearts.

On this Christmas Eve, let us stand in awe and wonder as the shepherds did so long ago, as we spend some time at Bethlehem's manger, simply worshiping and adoring our Infant King.